Prevention Checklist

'Stay Safe Online': A Checklist for Indian College Students

This checklist is designed to help you, as a student in India, protect your digital identity and finances. Review this regularly.

General Security

- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Turn on 2FA for all critical accounts (email, university portals, social media). This adds a second layer of security even if your password is stolen.
- **Create Strong, Unique Passwords:** Use a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols for all accounts. Never use easy-to-guess information like your date of birth or your college's name.

Phishing and Malware

- **Verify "Unsubscribe" and External Links:** Never click on suspicious links or download attachments from unknown emails or SMS, especially those promising job offers, scholarships, or free mobile recharges. This is a common phishing tactic.
- **Keep Software and Apps Updated:** Ensure your phone's operating system and all your apps (including banking apps) are updated to patch security vulnerabilities.

Social Media and Privacy

- **Review Privacy Settings:** Adjust your social media privacy settings (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn) to limit who can see your personal details, like your phone number or college ID. This prevents attackers from profiling you.
- **Be Mindful of What You Share:** Avoid publicly posting photos of your college ID, admit cards, or your flight tickets, which contain sensitive personal identifiers (like PRN, admission number).

Financial & UPI Safety (India-Specific)

- **NEVER Enter Your UPI PIN to RECEIVE Money:** This is the golden rule. Entering your UPI PIN is always an *authorizing* action to *send* money. Anyone asking you to enter your PIN to *receive* money is trying to scan you.
- **Check UPI Collect Requests Carefully:** Always double-check every UPI payment request notification. Verify the sender's UPI ID (VPA) and the amount before you even think about entering your PIN. Scammers often create IDs that look like official bank accounts.

Reporting Channel

- If you face any cybercrime, immediately report it to:
    - The National Cyber Crime Portal.
    - Call the toll-free helpline number: **1930**